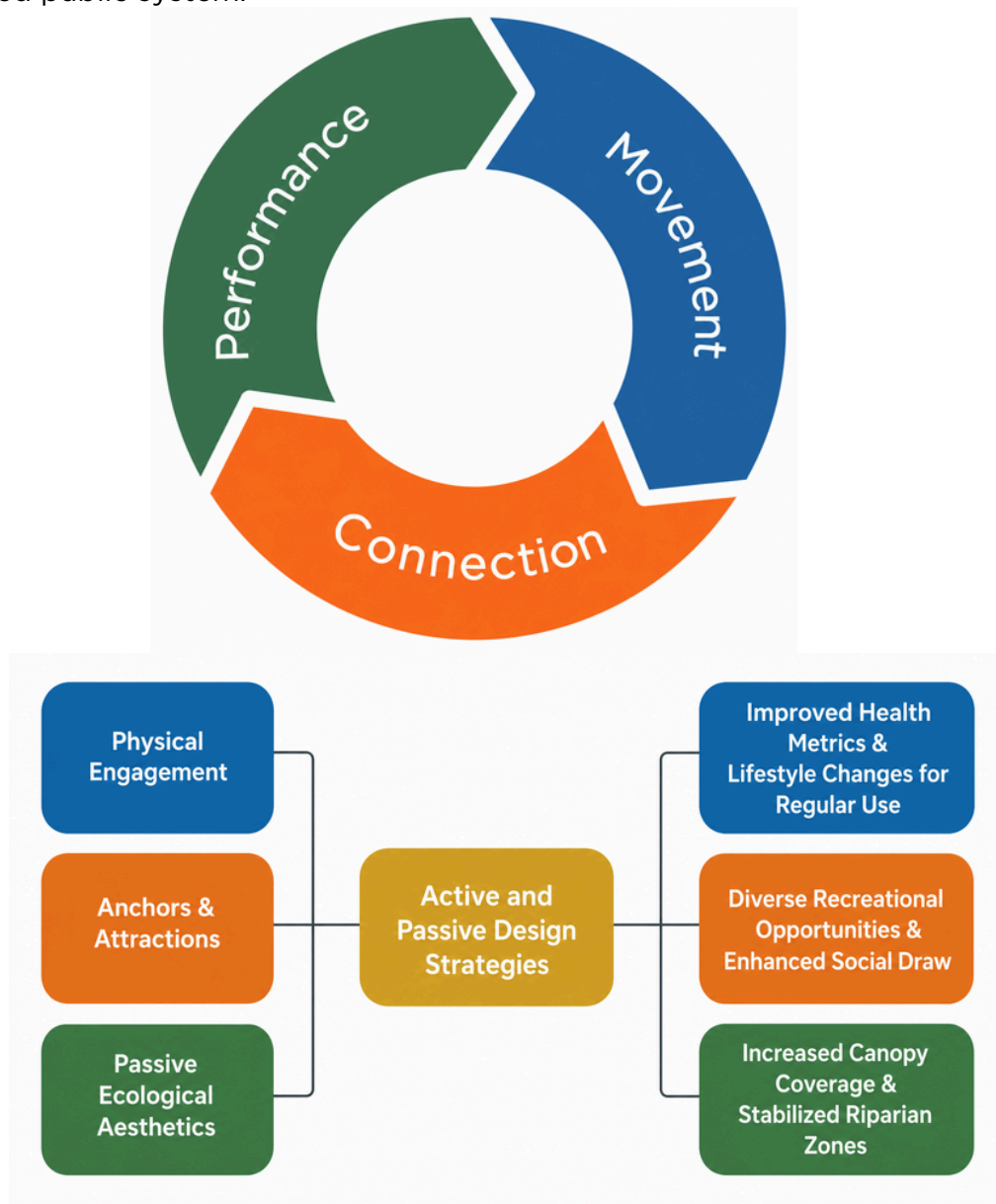


Project Framing

The inventory and analysis clarify that the site is shaped by three overlapping conditions. Lawrence County faces elevated public health risk. The surrounding recreation network lacks enough connected, low-barrier, everyday-use space. The site itself sits within an active floodplain where water is a recurring condition rather than an exception. Together, these pressures frame the project as more than a park redesign. They define it as a landscape problem in which ecology, movement, and public life have to be resolved together.

Proctor Landing Park is therefore framed as a public health landscape in which water functions as ecological infrastructure, movement functions as health infrastructure, and draw functions as social infrastructure. Their overlap forms the bridge of the project: a landscape that links habitat, daily activity, and community use through one coordinated public system.



Section 2 | Research + Precedents

This section establishes the research framework for the project and tests it through precedent. It moves from the core research question and comparative method into case studies that examine how built landscapes organize movement, ecology, social use, and measurable public value.



Research Approach and Precedent Lens

This section moves from research into precedent. Rather than treating the literature as a separate exercise, it is used here to establish the criteria for evaluating built landscapes relevant to Proctor Landing Park. The focus is on how parks can support ecological performance, public health, social use, flood adaptation, and everyday comfort.



The precedent lens looks at projects not only as finished designs, but as working landscape systems. Each case study is examined for how it organizes movement, manages water, creates habitat, supports recreation, and invites people to stay. This approach helps translate broad research themes into spatial decisions that can guide the master plan.

Across the precedents, the strongest lessons come from projects that layer multiple values into the same space. A trail can support exercise while also creating access to shade and habitat. A wetland can manage water while also becoming a memorable public destination. A gathering space can serve social life while improving comfort, visibility, and long-term park use. For Proctor Landing Park, the goal is to identify transferable strategies rather than copy formal design elements. The case studies are used to test how ecological infrastructure, active recreation, restorative landscapes, and flood-tolerant public space can work together. These lessons help frame the park as a connected system where health, ecology, and community are reinforced through everyday experience.



Case study questions

What problem does the project solve?
How does it organize movement, ecology, and use? What spatial strategies make it work?
What lessons can we transfer to Proctor Landing Park?



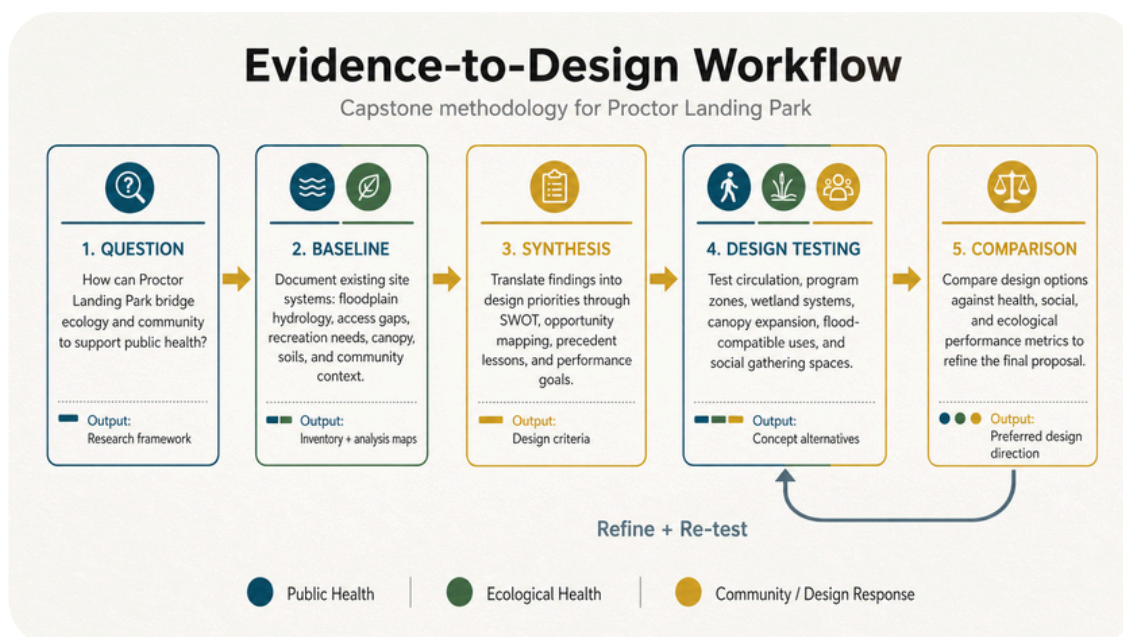
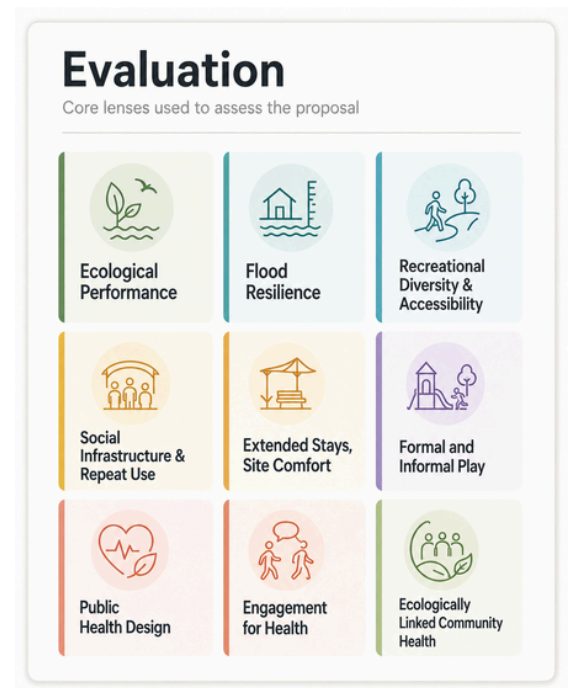
Research Question and Method

How can a redesign of Proctor Landing Park preserve or improve ecological function while supporting diverse, flood-resilient recreational opportunities that can measurably improve public health outcomes?

This was the research question developed early on in this process to inform the methods of design and desired outcomes.

This project uses a before-and-after comparative design method. Existing conditions are documented first through site inventory, mapping, and baseline performance metrics. Design proposals are then tested against those same measures to compare how changes in circulation, program placement, flood response, and ecological systems affect public health, access, and long-term site performance.

The method is organized around five research objectives: ecological systems, recreation and access, flood resilience and reliability of use, public health and spatial experience, and evaluation. Together, these establish a framework for measuring change rather than only describing it.



Case Study 01 | Kashmir Park, Bradford, UK

Community Co-Design, Natural Play & Everyday Active Use

Kashmir Park is a useful supporting precedent because it shows how a relatively small neighborhood park can support physical activity, social use, and ecological value at the same time. The project was developed through extensive consultation and is framed in the case-study source as a park intended to encourage more physical activity for children and the wider community.¹

The park is part of Bradford's JU:MP program, which aims to increase physical activity levels and improve health outcomes for children. An unused plot next to the Scotchman Road allotments was transformed into a public play park with natural play elements, trim trails, climbing equipment, flexible lawn, and a central gathering space sized for community events such as Eid celebrations. Unlike a conventional fenced play lot, the park was designed as a multi-use open space that supports both active play and informal community gathering.²



Its strongest lesson is the way co-design and access were developed together. Bradford City Council and JU:MP engaged the local community through the adjacent allotments and nearby schools, and children helped shape the design options. The final park has three entrances connecting directly to surrounding homes, creating shorter walking routes across the neighborhood and supporting active travel in place of short car trips.³

Kashmir Park is also relevant because it combines social and health goals with ecological performance. The case study notes the use of tree planting, wildflower grasslands, and sustainable drainage systems, along with basic council maintenance and visible local stewardship. For Proctor Landing Park, the key transferable lesson is not scale but method: build everyday destinations that combine direct neighborhood access, flexible use, natural systems, and a clear sense of community ownership.⁴

1. Sport England, Active Design Case Studies: Landscape Design—Helping to Create Active Environments, pp. 2–3.

2. Active Bradford, JU:MP Greenspace Developments; Growing Together Bradford / Kashmir Park project documentation.

3. Active Bradford. JU:MP Greenspace Developments.

Case Study 02 | The 606, Chicago, IL, USA

Adaptive Reuse, Active Mobility & Social Connectivity

The 606 is a 2.7-mile elevated linear park and multiuse trail built on a former freight rail line running through Chicago's Logan Square, Humboldt Park, Bucktown, and Wicker Park neighborhoods. Designed by Michael Van Valkenburgh Associates with the Trust for Public Land and managed by the Chicago Park District, the project opened in 2015 and reworked obsolete infrastructure into a continuous corridor for walking, cycling, recreation, and neighborhood connection.¹

What makes the project especially relevant is that it does more than provide a path. The 606 acts as a linked public-space system with 6 access parks, 13 access points, and connections to streets, transit, and adjacent neighborhood destinations. It reframes mobility infrastructure as civic landscape.²

Project data :

Location: Chicago, Illinois

Type: Elevated rail-trail / linear park

Length: 2.7 miles

Budget: \$95 million

Access parks: 6

Access points: 13

Railroad bridges adapted: 39

Residents within a 10-minute walk: 80,000, including 20,000 children



Existing Rail Infrastructure



Early Phase Planting Plans for Public Interest

Key design challenges:

Lack of open-space access in dense neighborhoods

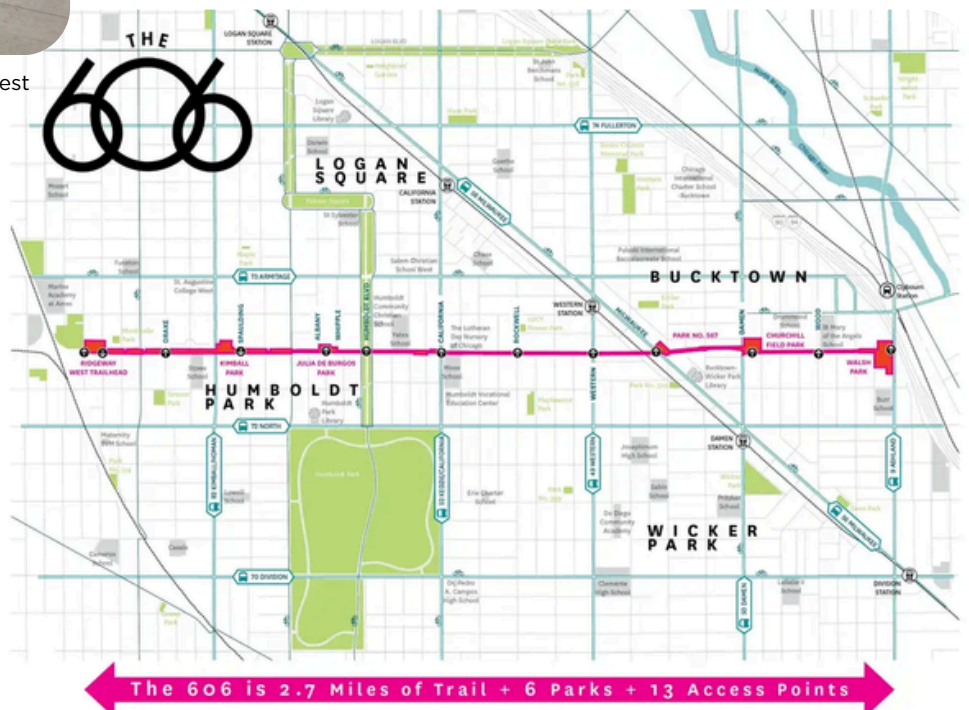
Disconnected neighborhood circulation

Need for recreation and transportation value

Adaptive reuse of deteriorated infrastructure

Need for safe, legible access across multiple communities

Balancing landscape identity with corridor efficiency



The 606 is a strong precedent for Proctor Landing Park because it shows how a landscape can organize movement, draw, and ecological value through one continuous public system. It is especially useful as a model for turning circulation into a primary design experience rather than a leftover connector.³

1. Michael Van Valkenburgh Associates, "The 606"; American Society of Landscape Architects, "The 606," 2020 Professional Awards.

2. ASLA 2020 Professional Awards summary; MVVA project page.

3. MVVA project page; ASLA Professional Awards.

Case Study 02 | The 606, Chicago, IL, USA

Performance, Benefits, and Cautions

The 606 was designed to be heavily used, and evidence suggests it succeeded in becoming a major recreation and mobility corridor. ASLA reports more than 1 million annual visitors, while post- occupancy research describes it as the only elevated multiuse trail in the United States and documents substantial use during its first three years of operation.¹

The project provides a safe and attractive setting for walking, jogging, bicycling, commuting, and everyday recreation. Its continuous grade-separated route reduces interruption, improves legibility, and supports active transportation alongside leisure use. For Proctor Landing Park, this reinforces the value of designing movement infrastructure as a primary public-health system rather than a secondary amenity.²

The 606 is not a simple success story. Research from the Institute for Housing Studies at DePaul University found that the trail had limited effect in the already strong eastern market, but a much stronger impact in the lower-income western portion of the corridor. In 606 West, single-family house prices increased 48.2 percent since groundbreaking, and properties within one-fifth of a mile of the trail commanded a 22.3 percent price premium, equal to more than \$100,000 above the area's average 2015 sales price.³

Transferable lessons for Proctor Landing Park

- Make movement a primary spatial system.
- Connect circulation to destinations, not just edges.
- Use planting to make infrastructure feel civic and inhabitable
- Treat access as both functional and social.
- Pair public investment with equity awareness and long-term community benefit planning.



1. American Society of Landscape Architects, "The 606"; Greg Lindsey et al., "The 606 at Three: Trends in Use of Chicago's Elevated Rail-Trail."
2. MVVA project page; Lindsey et al., 2019.
3. Institute for Housing Studies at DePaul University, Measuring the Impact of The 606, 2016.